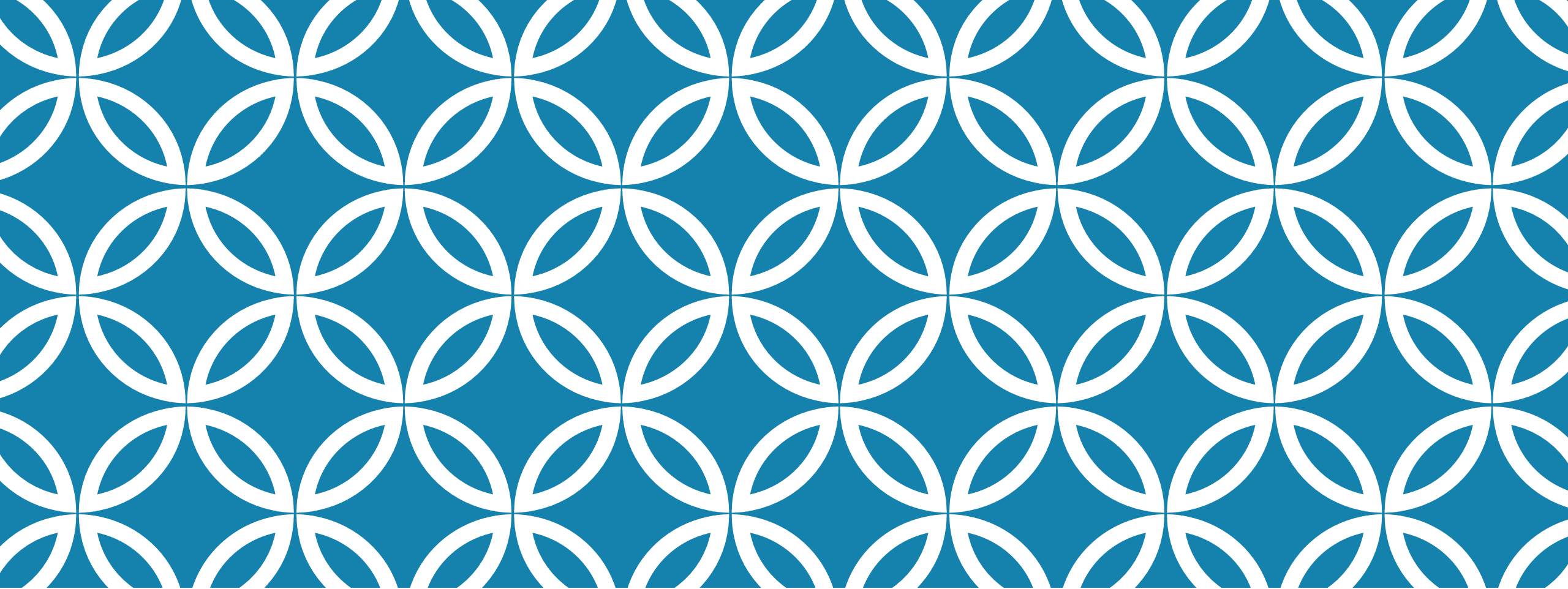
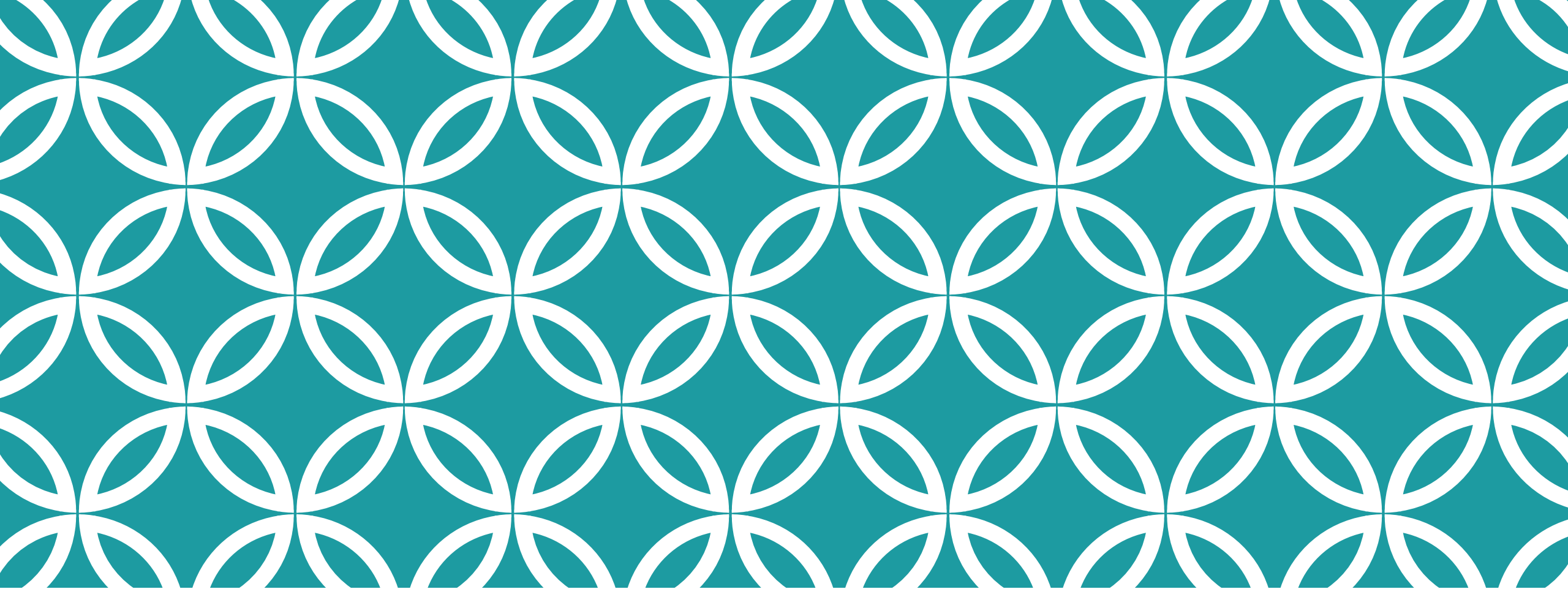




PUBP309: EDUCATION POLICY

Education Policies in Colonial India 1854-1882
Woods despatch to Hunters Commission

Shivakumar Jolad
FLAME University



EDUCATIONAL DESPATCH 1854 (WOOD'S DISPATCH)



EDUCATIONAL DESPATCH- SIGNIFICANCE

CHAPTER IX.

THE EDUCATIONAL DESPATCHES OF 1854 AND 1859 AND THE UNIVERSITIES' ACTS OF 1857.

The despatch of the Court of Directors of 1854 has been described as "The Magna Charta of English Education in India." In his minute Lord Dalhousie declared that it contained "a scheme of education for all India, far wider and more comprehensive than the Local or the Supreme Government could ever have ventured to suggest." An immediate outcome of this despatch was the passing of the three University Acts of 1857 (128-130).

The principle and policy of the despatch of 1854 were reaffirmed and amplified by that of 1859 which reviewed the action taken on the earlier despatch.

BUREAU OF EDUCATION, INDIA

SELECTIONS

FROM

EDUCATIONAL RECORDS

PART II

1840-1859

J. A. RICHEY, C.I.E.



CALCUTTA
SUPERINTENDENT GOVERNMENT PRINTING, INDIA
1922

DISPATCH- CONTENTS

(126) Despatch from the Court of Directors of the East India Company, to the Governor General of India in Council,—(No. 49, dated the 19th July 1854).

*(126) Des-
patch of 1854.*

It appears to us that the present time, when by an Act of the Imperial Legislature the responsible trust of the Government of India has again been placed in our hands, is peculiarly suitable for the review of the progress which has already been made, the supply of existing deficiencies, and the adoption of such improvements as may be best calculated to secure the ultimate benefit of the people committed to our charge.

2. Among many subjects of importance, none can have a stronger claim to our attention than that of education. It is one of our most sacred duties to be the means, as far as in us lies, of conferring upon the natives of India those vast moral and material blessings which flow from the general diffusion of useful knowledge, and which India may, under Providence, derive from her connexion with England. For although British influence has already in many remarkable instances, been

Aims and objectives of the Despatch

Introductory Paragraph: Reasons for making Despatch:

- Among many subjects of importance, none can have a stronger claim to our attention than that of education. It is one of our most sacred duties to be the means, as far as in us lies, of conferring upon the natives of India those vast moral and material blessings which flow from the general diffusion of useful knowledge, and which India may, under Providence, derive from her connexion with England. For although **British influence has already in many remarkable instances, been applied with great energy and success to uproot demoralising practices and even crimes of a deeper dye, which for ages had prevailed among the natives of India, ..**
- We have moreover, always looked upon the encouragement of education as peculiarly important, because calculated "not only to produce a higher degree of intellectual fitness, but to raise the moral character of those who partake of its advantages, and so **to supply you with servants** to whose probity you may with increased confidence commit offices of trust" in India, where the well-being of the people is so intimately connected with the truthfulness and ability of officers of every grade in all departments of the State.
- .. **this knowledge will teach the natives of India the marvellous results of the employment of labor and capital, rouse them to emulate us** in the development of the vast resources of their country

Nature of Education Despatch

- **Stress on Western Knowledge**

7. Before proceeding further, we must emphatically declare that the education which we desire to see extended in India is that which has for its object the diffusion of the improved arts, science, philosophy and literature of Europe ; in short of European knowledge.

13. It is neither our aim nor desire to substitute the English language for the vernacular dialects of the country. We have always been most sensible of the importance of the use of the languages which alone are understood by the great mass of the population. These languages, and not English, have been put by us in the

- **Secondary and higher education must be English**

Dept of Education and Expansion of mass education

- **Creation of Department of Education:** The Wood's Despatch, for the first time, recommended the **creation of a Department of Public Instruction in each of the five provinces of Bengal, Bombay, Madras, the Punjab and the North Western provinces.**
- **Expansion of Mass Education:** Emphasis was given on the increase of setting up primary, middle and high schools.
- **Discarding of the The Downward Filtration Theory :** The importance to primary education was stressed. **Elementary education was considered to be the foundation of the education system.**

Education Despatch-1854- from -Selections from educational records-II, 1840- 1859, J A Richey

KKHSOU: course on education history

Grant in Aid Schools and Teacher Training

- **Grant - in-aid system:** Direct establishment of schools by government to masses was difficult. Grants were given to those schools and colleges which satisfied the conditions such as :
 - a) The schools must provide secular education.
 - c) The school should agree to **state inspection from time to time**

52. We have, therefore, resolved to adopt in India the system of grants-in-aid which has been carried out in this country with very great success ; and we confidently anticipate, by thus drawing support from local resources in addition to contributions from the State, a far more rapid progress of education than would follow a mere increase of expenditure by the Government ; while it possesses the additional

- **Training of Teachers:** - The Wood's Despatch recommended the **establishment of teacher training schools in each of the provinces.**
 - There should be training schools for **teachers of engineering, medicine and law.**

Education Despatch-1854- from -Selections from educational records-II, 1840- 1859, J A Richey

Establishment of Universities

conclusion that the time is now arrived for the establishment of universities in India, which may encourage a regular and liberal course of education by conferring academical degrees as evidences of attainments in the different branches of art and science, and by adding marks of honour for those who may desire to compete for honorary distinction.

- The Despatch recommended the **establishment of universities in the three Presidency towns of Calcutta, Bombay and Madras.**
- The universities were to **be modeled after the London University** and these were to have a senate comprising of a **Chancellor, a Vice-Chancellor**, and fellows who were nominated by the Government.
- The Universities would confer degrees to the successful candidates after passing the examinations, (of Science or Arts Streams) conducted by the Senate. The universities were to organize departments not only of **English** but also of **Arabic, Sanskrit and Persian, as well as law and civil engineering.** it would greatly encourage the cultivation of the vernacular languages of India that professorships should be founded for those languages, and perhaps also for Sanskrit, Arabic and Persian. A knowledge of the Sanskrit language, the

AFFILIATION SYSTEM

Function of university – confer degrees to students in affiliated colleges

27. The function of the universities will be to confer degrees upon such persons as, having been entered as candidates according to the rules which may be fixed in this respect, and having produced from any of the “affiliated institutions” which will be enumerated on the foundation of the universities, or be from time to

Religious neutrality

28. The examinations for degrees will not include any subjects connected with religious belief; and affiliated institutions will be under the management of persons of every variety of religious persuasion. As in England, various in-

Education of Women

- The Despatch recommended that the government should always support education for women.

83. The importance of female education in India cannot be over-rated ; and we have observed with pleasure the evidence which is now afforded of an increased desire on the part of many of the natives of India to give a good education to their daughters. By this means a far greater proportional impulse is imparted to the educational and moral tone of the people than by the education of men.

We have already observed that schools for females are included among those to which grants-in-aid may be given and we cannot refrain from expressing our cordial sympathy with the efforts which are being made in this direction.

Report on Public Instruction,
Bengal, 1849-1850, page 2.

- **Encouraged the private enterprises to promote women education.**
The schools for girls were to be included among those to which grants-in-aid would be given

Teaching Language and Professional Education

- **Language:** The Wood's Despatch gave importance to teaching of English, but at the same time, it also stressed on the teaching of Indian languages. **The Despatch clearly stated that Indian languages as well as English should be used as media of instruction**
- **Professional Education:** The Wood's Despatch encouraged professional education. **It recommended the establishment of medical, engineering law and other institutes of professional education.** The Despatch stated that in order to develop vocational efficiency of people and also to make people realise that the British rule was progressive. Another reason for the encouragement of vocational education was to control the problem of unemployment.

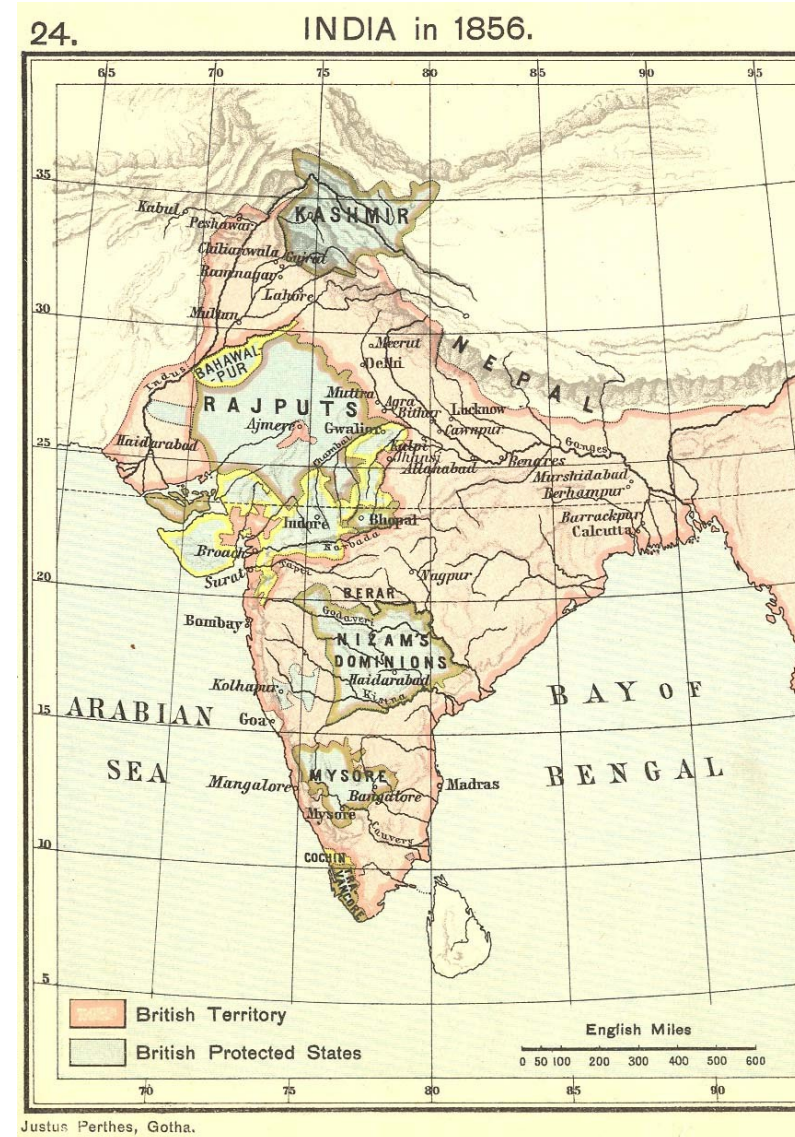
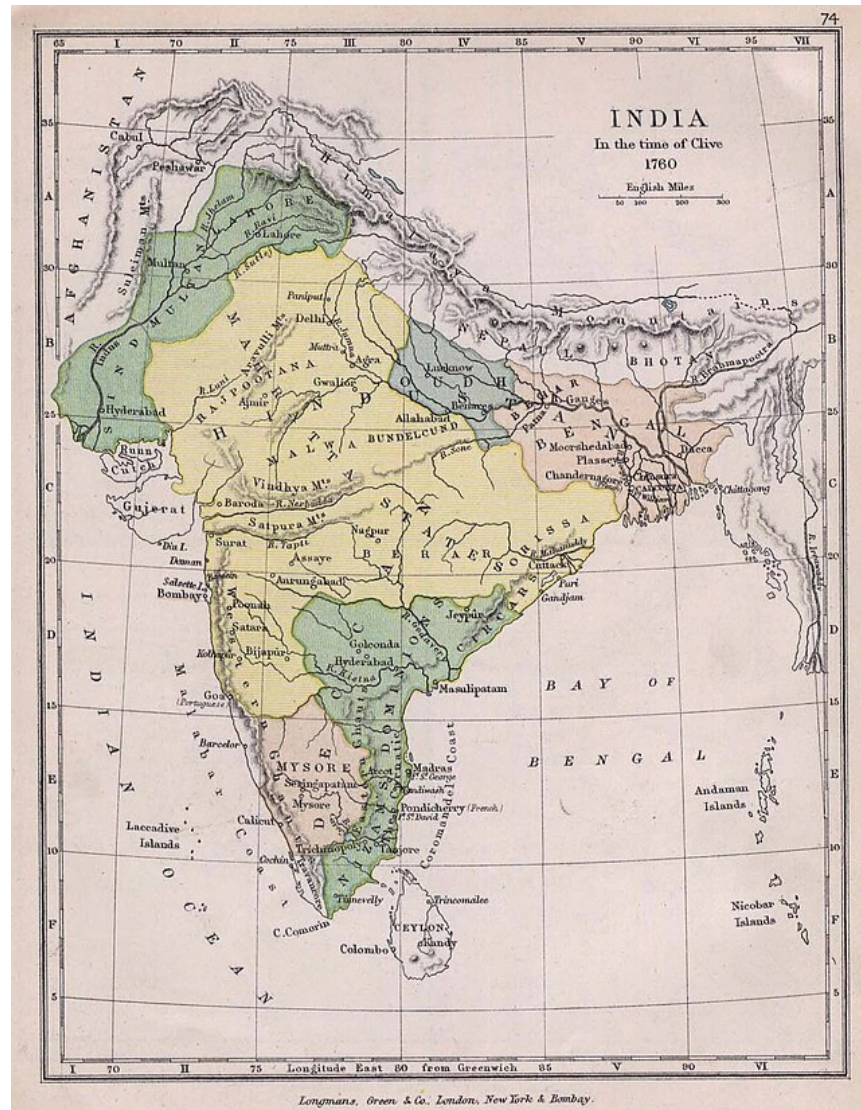
Observations- Critique of Despatch

- Richter – History of Missions in India, called Education Despatch as the “**Magna Carta of Indian Education**”
- Acknowledge multitude of contributions to Indian education system.
 - Thomason- acknowledged, but Dalhousie is missed
- Primarily recognized employment as a major reason for education: vocational education – labor, employment in govt services were encouraged
- Some Indians (M R Paranjape, J P Naik, Nurullah) critiqued it for **not emphasizing universalization of education..** --- But context, in 18th century should be kept in mind. British themselves did not have compulsory education till 1860's.

Implementation of Despatch and endorsement in 1859

- 1855 Dalhousie laid proposals for working out Despatch.. Set up Department of superintendence of Education, Director of public Instruction established. Work started on setting up universities in Calcutta, Bombay and Madras.
- **1857 Revolt.**- Apprehensions that Edu policies helped Indians to raise for the revolt. Queens proclamation 1858- British Crown overtook the control of India. **President of the board-- > Secretary of State for India.**
- **Lord Stanley** – first secretary of state endorsed the Despatch in 1859. Suggested instead of depending on grant in aid, should go for direct establishment of elementary schools... Suggested leveling local taxes for funding these schools.

INDIA UNDER EAST INDIA COMPANY 1760-1857



A map by Longmans, 1905, showing India in 1760

"Historical Atlas of India," by Charles Joppen (London: Longmans, Green & Co., 1907)

QUEENS PROCLAMATION- 1858

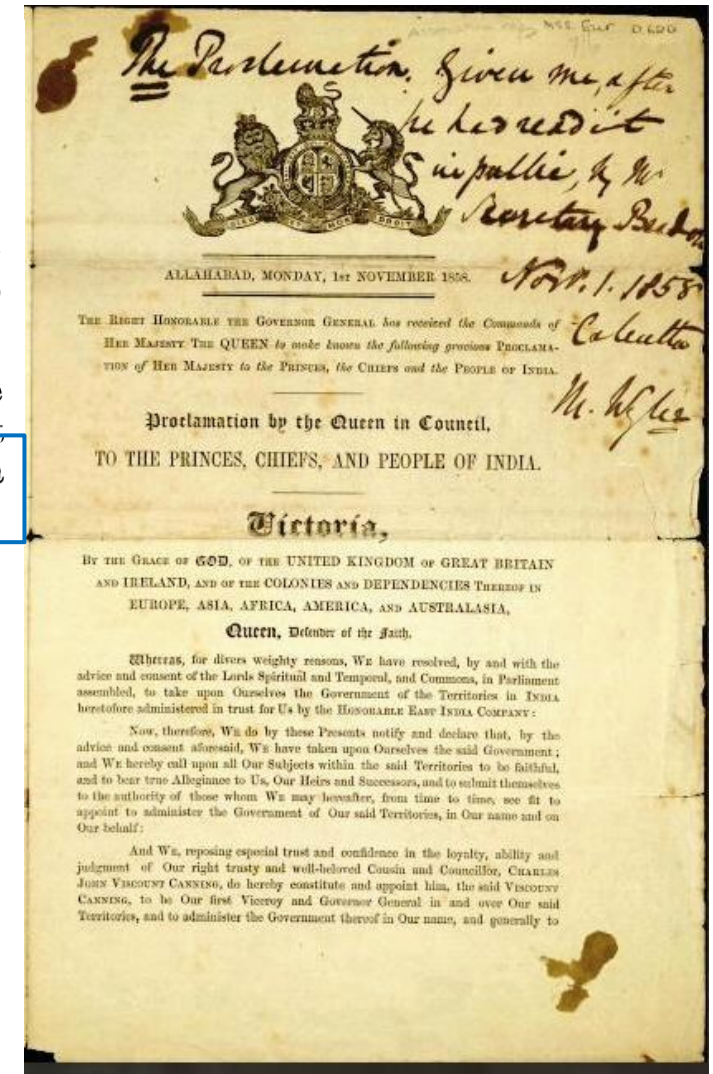
PROCLAMATION by the QUEEN IN COUNCIL to the PRINCES,
CHIEFS, and PEOPLE of INDIA (published by the GOVERNOR-GENERAL at
ALLAHABAD, November 1st, 1858).

VICTORIA, by the Grace of God of the United Kingdom of Great Britain and
Ireland, and of the Colonies and Dependencies thereof in Europe, Asia, Africa,
America, and Australasia, Queen, Defender of the Faith.

Whereas, for divers weighty reasons, We have resolved, by and with the advice
and consent of the Lords Spiritual and Temporal, and Commons, in Parliament
assembled, to take upon Ourselves the Government of the Territories in India
heretofore administered in trust for Us by the Honorable East India Company :

We desire no extensions of our present territorial possessions.. We shall respect the rights, dignity, and honor of Native Princes as Our own ;

Whatever race or creed, be freely and impartially admitted to offices in our service, the duties of which they may be qualified, by their education, ability, and integrity, duly to discharge



MAIN EVENTS OF THE PERIOD

Organization of the Education Department;

the creation of a new system of primary schools- supported partly by local rates and fees and partly by Government grants

Development of the system of grant-in-aid; Establishment of the Universities and substantial extension of collegiate and secondary education;

Westernization of the content of education and its results;

Neglect of indigenous schools leading to their almost complete disappearance by 1902;

Development of education among women, Muslims, Lower castes, aboriginals, and the development of modern education in Indian States.



Lord Canning
1858-63



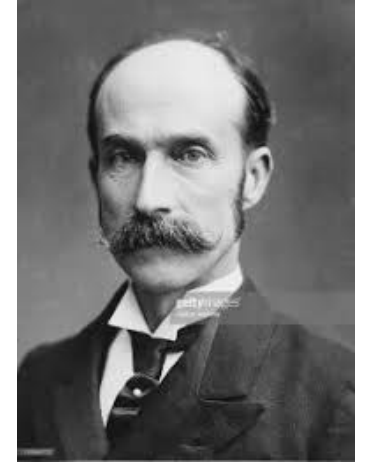
Lord Mayo
1869-72



Lord Lytton
1876-1880



Lord Ripon
1880-1884



Lord Lansdowne
1888-1894

Viceroy of India In Victorian Period



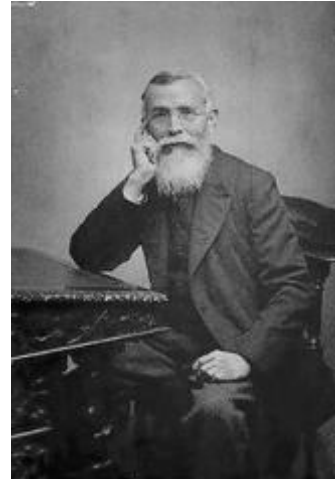
Jyotirao Phule



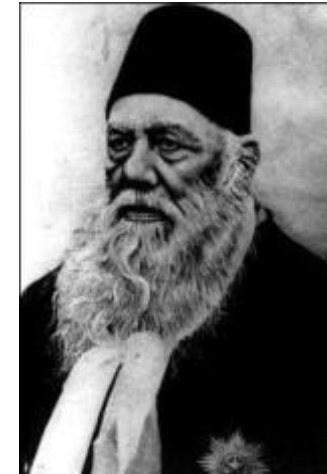
Savitribai Phule



Tarabhai Shinde



Dadabhai Naoroji



**Sayyid Ahmed
Khan**



**Ishwar Chandra
Vidyasagar**

MAKERS OF MODERN INDIA IN VICTORIAN PERIOD

Higher education: 1854-1882

- **Establishment of Universities in Calcutta, Madras and Bombay** on the basis of University of London,
- Purpose was (largely limited) to award degrees to deserving candidates in Arts, Science, Commerce,
- Modeled: Chancellor (Governor), Vice Chancellor, Members. Total at least 30. fellows appointed for life.
- **Affiliation to university was *not* limited by geographical location.** Calcutta University- catered to Bengal, Assam, and Ceylon.
- Main purpose of college was to **prepare students for exams!**

Affiliated colleges

- Hindu College- > presidency College; Madras High school-> **Presidency college at Madras**
- University College- Lahore-> Punjab University, Munir Central College-> **Allahabad University**
- Some Indians set up colleges themselves: Canning College-by Oudh talukdars, Lucknow- > Lucknow university, Mohammadian Anglo Oriental Colleges (1875)-> **Aligarh Muslim University**
- Rajkot College, **Mayo College- Ajmer.**, Daly College, Indore,
- Missionary college: **St Xavier College-** Calcutta (1860), Bombay (1869), **St Stephens College** – Delhi (1882),
- 1876: **Indian Association of Cultivation of Science (IACS)-** Mahendra Lal Sarcar



Secondary Education and Medium of Instruction

- Liberal grant in aid policy led to tremendous increase in secondary schools- **set up mostly by Indians!**
- **Indian secondary schools overtook the missionary schools** in short time.
1882- Indians 1341 schools, missionaries 747.
- **English was chosen as medium of instruction in most schools, contrary to the suggestions of the charter**.. Colleges and Universities needed English, schools began to cater to them by creating English matriculated students.
- Students wanted matriculation certificates to qualify for clerical jobs in govt establishments

Elementary Education

- **Missionaries continued to lead in Elementary Education.** 1854- 36,000 pupils in Govt schools, Missionaries had more than twice that number.
 - 1881-82: 82,916 schools , 20.61 lakh students studying in it.
- **Stanley's Despatch 1859:** Instead of grant-in-Aid, local cess should be levied for funding schools... This led to reversal of Despatch order on mass education through grant in aid.
- Stanley's Despatch created dilemma among provincial govts: Bengal, Assam and Madras, **attempted improvement of indigenous schools through grant in Aid**, created govt schools as models. Bombay, NWP, Punjab and Coorg neglected indigenous schools.

Indian Education Commission: 1882

- **Hunters commission: review of educational developments since 1854**
- In 1882 , Lord Rippon appointed education commission with William Hunter as the chairman.
- 20 members with many Indians in it.
- Particular emphasis was laid on **enquiring to primary education**.
- **England passed Elementary education Act in 1870, and then 1873, 1876 and 1880 (compulsory age of attendance at school until the age of 10).**
- Report submitted in 1883- 222 resolutions



Sir William Wilson Hunter (1840-1900)

Hunters Commission: Key recommendations

- **Transfer of government secondary schools and colleges to private bodies** (were given grant in aid)
- **Supported indigenous schools** (established by natives of India on native methods). Management was left to municipal boards, and **were given autonomy to develop curriculum, method of teaching and examination !**
- Main **efforts should be on elementary education of masses**, (provision, extension and improvement)– **given to local bodies**
- Primary education curriculum: emphasized **Practical aspects** (mensuration, arithmetic, natural and physical sciences)

PRIVATE INDIAN ENTERPRISE

1854: private enterprise really meant missionary enterprise.

1882: changed and **Indians occupied a fairly important position in education**

Motives: **1880-wave of social, religious, and political reforms in India**— a veritable beginning of a renaissance in **Indian national life**.

Nation building : for social and political reforms the education of the country's youth came to be controlled and managed by Indians themselves.

Mahomedan Anglo-Oriental College at Aligarh and the Deccan Education Society of Poona

Institutions in 1882

Institutions	Conducted by Indian Managers	Conducted by other than Indian Managers
Arts Colleges	5	18
Secondary Schools	1,341	757
Primary Schools	54,662	1,842
Professional Colleges and Schools	10	18
Total	66,018	2,635

N.B. Figures for British India and some Indian States (exclusive of Burma)

“It was these nameless sons of Mother India that satisfied as well as created the public demand for more education that grew up at this time and thereby laid the foundation of the modern national life in India.” - N&N